

Debargha Som

Research Associate, Centre for Advanced Financial Research and Learning (CAFRAL)
Reserve Bank of India, Mumbai, India

debargha.som@cafral.org.in
debargha.som@gmail.com
+91 98830-14861
LinkedIn — GitHub

EDUCATION

M.Sc in Economics

Aug 2023 – May 2025

Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur (IIT Kanpur)

Cumulative Performance Index (CPI): **8.70**/10.0

Master's Thesis: Understanding the Influence of Financial Frictions on Business Cycles in India: A DSGE Perspective.

B.Sc (Honours) in Economics

Aug 2020 – Aug 2023

Minor in Mathematics & Statistics

Scottish Church College, University of Calcutta

Grade: **8.579**/10.0 [Letter Grade: **A+**]; awarded with Distinction.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Associate

Jun 2025 – Present

Centre for Advanced Financial Research and Learning (CAFRAL), Reserve Bank of India, Mumbai

Supervisor: Dr. Nirupama Kulkarni

Working on multiple projects at the intersection of banking, monetary policy, and consumer finance using confidential administrative micro-data (BSR, DBIE, TransUnion CIBIL, pincode shapefiles):

- **Causal Inference (Fintech & Credit):** UPI credit-access effects via event studies/CiC²; 20-yr ECB dataset (2004–2026) via DiD/RDD for RBI DSGE parameters.
- **Structural & Mechanism Identification:** BLP demand estimation on savings products; zombie-lending replication isolating PSB capital constraints over political-channel explanations.
- **Geospatial Analysis & Survey Design:** Geocoding/fuzzy-matching on SBI mortgage data for appraisal-gap effects; sampling design for RBI's Financial Inclusion Index Survey.
- **Data Infrastructure:** Digitised DBIE supervisory dataset into Stata-ready files; built first NIC-to-MCC mapping; Git/Dropbox research workflow.
- **Monetary Policy Committee (Aug 2026):** Local Projections & Bayesian SVAR for MPC presentation on India's household wealth channel and consumption transmission.

Research Intern

Feb 2024 – Jul 2024

International Water Management Institute (IWMI), Colombo, Sri Lanka

Research group: Investment and Institutional Analysis for RRR Business Development.

RESEARCH PROJECTS AND ARTICLES

Where Deposit Market Power Lives in Indian Banking

Work in Progress

Single-authored.

Despite India's 2011 deregulation of savings deposit rates, competition for deposits isn't delivering the price discipline it should. I show that this reflects depositors' bank-group preferences, driven by varying degrees of government influence across bank types. Using demand estimation on annual bank data, I find that the Indian deposit market behaves inelastically over time and across bank groups. Private banks face relatively less inelastic demand than other banks. My results suggest that a depositor who leaves a bank is 4 to 11 times more likely to land at a bank within the same group. I further document a flexible method to derive conservative Rupee value estimates of repo rate pass-through for any bank, year, or bank-group.

Policy Articles

Chakrabarti, K.; Ravikumar, B.; **Som, D.** "Velocity of money: The invisible pulse of the economy." *FRED Blog*, May 7, 2026. 

Chakrabarti, K.; Ravikumar, B.; **Som, D.** "India's long work year." *FRED Blog*, April 9, 2026. 

Taron, A.; **Som, D.**; *et al.* (2024). "Green bonds to facilitate circular bioeconomy in urban centers." IWMI, Colombo. 

HONOURS & AWARDS

- **Shrimati Madhuri Dubey Scholarship** (2025) – Awarded to **2 out of 1500 Master's students** by IIT Kanpur for academic excellence.

- **MCM Scholarship** (2024–25, Odd Semester) – Awarded to top **5% of M.Sc class** at IIT Kanpur; tuition fees and additional stipend.
- **CUET 2023 – Top 0.5%** nationally (of over 38,000 candidates).
- **GATE 2023** (XH-C1, Economics) – **top 1%** nationally.
- Ranked among **top 50** of 3,000 students across 100+ affiliated colleges.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Tutor , ECO251 – Econometrics I, IIT Kanpur Conducted tutorial lectures; prepared tutorial materials; graded assignments.	<i>Spring 2025</i>
Teaching Assistant , NOC25-MA58 – Probability and Stochastics for Finance (NPTEL) Prepared weekly assignments; assisted students on the course forum; graded submissions.	<i>Spring 2025</i>

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Standardized Tests: GRE (168Q 151V 3.5AWA)
Languages & Tools: Stata, Python, Matlab, R.
Databases: DBIE (RBI), TransUnion CIBIL, BSR, LSEG, CEIC, RBI DSIM
Methods: Structural demand estimation (BLP/nested logit), Causal inference (DiD, RDD, CiC, Bartik IV, event studies), Geospatial analysis, Time series, DSGE modelling, Financial econometrics, Bayesian econometrics.

SELECTED COURSEWORK

Graduate: Advanced Macroeconomics (**A**), Applied Macroeconomics (**A***), Econometrics I (**A**), Advanced Econometrics (**A**), Bayesian Econometrics (**A**), Everyday Macroeconomics with Data (**A**), Foundations of Financial Risk (**A**), Financial Econometrics, Time Series Analysis.
Undergraduate: Mathematics Sequence III (GE3) – Real Analysis, Calculus I (**A++**); Mathematics Sequence IV (GE4) – Calculus II–III, incl. multivariable (**A+**).

MISC INFORMATION

- Head of Sponsorship & Finance Manager, *Econverge '22* (Scottish Church College Annual Economics Fest). Obtained funds from 6 corporate patrons and other individuals to finance Rs.60,000/- event, in two weeks.
- **NSS Unit Leader**, Scottish Church College (Aug 2022 – Jul 2023): Conducted Economic Survey and Organized NSS Special Camp. Overlooked and acquired finances for recurring annual events.
- **Community Teaching**, Sabuj Mon outreach programme: Taught underprivileged children from urban slums (Aug 2022 – Jul 2023).
- **Languages:** English (fluent), Bengali (native), Hindi (proficient)

REFERENCES

Dr. Nirupama Kulkarni Professor CAFRAL, Reserve Bank of India Mumbai nirupama.kulkarni@cafral.org.in	Dr. Joydeep Dutta Professor, Dept. of Economic Sciences IIT Kanpur jdutta@iitk.ac.in	Dr. Sounak Thakur Asst. Professor, Dept. of Economic Sciences IIT Kanpur sounakt@iitk.ac.in
---	--	---